

1762

CATHERINE THE GREAT SEIZES POWER IN RUSSIA

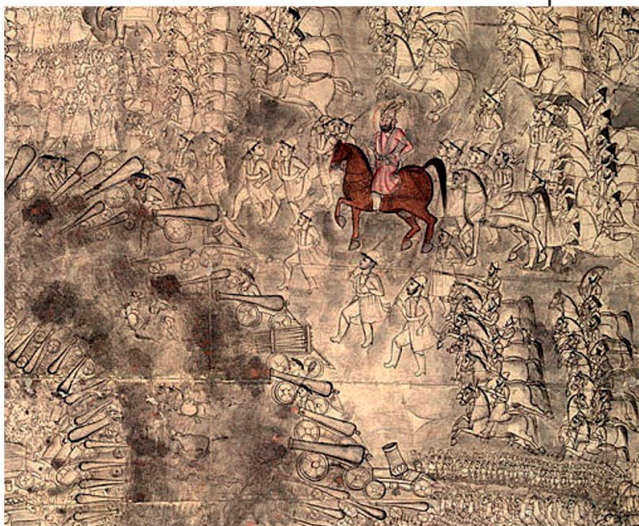
A German princess, Catherine (1729-96) married Emperor Peter III of Russia in 1745. She developed a deep love for the country and, on 28 June 1762, led a coup to rid Russia of its erratic, reactionary emperor and was proclaimed empress. She proved to be an enlightened monarch, reforming Russia's administration, raising its prestige in Europe, and extending its territories.

▷ Empress Catherine II of Russia



1760

1760 Tacky's War sees a major uprising of enslaved West Africans brutally crushed in Jamaica



△ Third battle of Panipat in northern India

1761

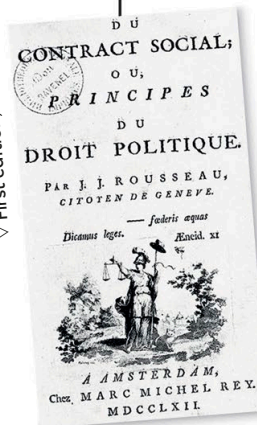
BATTLE OF PANIPAT

Ahmad Shah Durrani led the Afghans to victory in a bloody battle against the Marathas, who dominated much of India. The battle of Panipat ended the Afghan-Maratha War (from 1757) and destroyed Maratha hopes of succeeding the Mughals as rulers of India, but left a dangerous power vacuum in northern India that Britain would exploit.

1763 John Harrison's

chronometer transforms navigation at sea by allowing longitude to be determined

▽ First edition, title page



1762

JEAN JACQUES ROUSSEAU PUBLISHES HIS SOCIAL CONTRACT

Declaring that "man is born free but is everywhere in chains", Rousseau argued that people could only experience true freedom by living in a civil society that ensured the rights and well-being of all its citizens – a revolutionary idea at the time.